5B

wish for present / future

wish + past simple

I wish I **was** ten years younger! 5.17
I wish I **could** understand what they're saying.
I wish we **didn't live** so far from my parents.

- We use *wish* + person / thing + past simple to talk about things we would like to be different in the present / future (but which are impossible or unlikely).
- After *wish*, you can use *was* or *were* with *I*, *he*, *she*, and *it*, e.g. *I wish I was / were taller.*

wish + *would* / *wouldn't*

I wish the bus **would come**. I'm freezing. 5.18
I wish you**'d spend** a bit more time with the children.
I wish you **wouldn't leave** your shoes there. I always fall over them.
I wish cyclists **wouldn't cycle** on the pavement!

- We use *wish* + person / thing + *would* / *wouldn't* to talk about things we want to happen, or stop happening, because they annoy us.
- You can't use *wish* + *would* for a wish about yourself, i.e. **NOT** ~~*I wish I would...*~~, ~~*I wish we would...*~~.

wish for past regrets

wish + past perfect

I wish I**'d worked** harder at school. 5.21
I wish I **hadn't spoken** to him like that!
I wish she**'d told** me the truth about her feelings.

- We use *wish* + past perfect to talk about things that happened or didn't happen in the past and which we now regret.

> ***if only...***
> *if only* is sometimes used instead of *I wish* in certain situations, to express deep regret, e.g. *If only I had worked harder at school* (*I wouldn't have such a boring job now*).

a Write sentences with *I wish* + past simple for 1–5, and *I wish...would / wouldn't* for 6–10.

I'd like to be taller. *I wish I was taller.*
It annoys me that you don't put away your clothes.
I wish you'd put away your clothes!

I'd like these things to be different

1 I'd like to be fitter.
_____

2 I'd like my sister not to share a room with me.
_____

3 I'd like to be able to dance.
_____

4 I'd like my grandmother not to be dead.
_____

5 I'd like to live in a country with a better climate.
_____

It annoys me that...

6 shop assistants aren't more polite.
_____

7 you turn the heating up all the time.
_____

8 my brother doesn't tidy our room.
_____

9 the neighbour's dog barks at night.
_____

10 it doesn't stop raining.
_____

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b Rewrite the sentence beginning with *I wish* + past perfect.

I regret having written that email.
I wish *I hadn't written that email.*

1 I regret not seeing Prince live.
I wish I'd seen Prince live.

2 He regrets not learning to cook at school.
He wishes he'd learned to cook at school.

3 Do you regret buying a second-hand car?
Do you wish you hadn't bought a second-hand car?

4 Jenny regrets marrying her first husband.
Jenny wishes she hadn't married her first husband.

5 My parents regret moving to the country.
My parents wish they hadn't moved to the country.

6 Does Tom regret not studying law?
Does Tom wish he'd studied law?

7 I regret having my hair cut so short.
I wish I hadn't had my hair cut so short.

8 They regret not going to the wedding.
They wish they'd gone to the wedding.

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